

Lowlight cameras under 15k

We gathered cameras powered by a BSI Sensor costing less than 15k and tested their prowess <http://dgit.in/1aMYyJu>



LG G2 in India

By the time you get your hands on this magazine, LG will have released its G2 smartphone in India

isn't missed. The tablet has a textured rubberized finish, which adds to the grip, and the tablet is really comfortable to hold. The build quality of the tablet was questionable when it was launched but it is decent for a tablet priced at ₹14,000. The 7-inch form factor is small enough to carry around and still has the potential to be a great tablet.

Coming to the second generation Nexus, this tablet made our jaws drop to the ground with its design and build. It isn't wider than its predecessor but is taller. This time around there is a rear-facing camera as well. The device is really slim and the back has a smooth matte rubberized finish, which is very comfortable to hold. The tablet also showcases stereo speakers and you hear them to their fullest potential while watching action videos. The tablet has a set of speaker on either side of the micro USB port and a single strip at the opposite end. It is easy to cover the speakers with your hands while holding the device in landscape mode, but this didn't really affect the performance of the speakers greatly. Another design element that we like is that there is some space on the left and the right of the tablet (when held in landscape mode). This gives you real estate to hold the device properly without covering the screen. This may not

be a big deal for some, but considering the size of the tablet, we think it is nifty. Simply put, this is the best-built tablet of the lot.

Features and performance

All the tablets in this shootout run on the Android OS. But that doesn't mean that their performance is the same.

Starting with the Zync tri-plets, the 8-inch tablet is the best performer of the three. The OS and interface is the same on all the three tablets. They all run on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean. You have access to five customizable home screens and the back, home and multitasking buttons are a part of the display. You also have access to the volume controls and a screenshot button that rests near the multitasking button. The tablets don't come with any preloaded bloatware and that is a good thing. The tablets comes with an app called the 4K VideoPlayer and it's hard to put this claim to the test since there is no 4K content available. The app essentially runs on three modes - Cool Mode, Optimization mode and the energy saving mode.

Coming to the real world performance, only the Zync Quad 8 is an impressive tablet. Even though it lagged at times, it wasn't a frustrating experience using the device. Apps installed and ran well and generally using the device was good. There were a few random app crashes, but nothing major to crib about. The display is average at best and has some decent viewing angles. The other two Zync tablets - the Quad 9.7 and the

Quad 10.1 were quite disastrous to use. The Quad 9.7 looks very impressive on paper with a 9.7-inch display showcasing a 2048x1536 pixels resolution. The specifications also looked fair enough to power such a high-resolution display. But this isn't the case in the real world performance. The tablet is plagued with lag and random crashes. Doing something as simple as switching between applications can be a tedious task. The device may have a nice display with good viewing angles but what's the point when the process of interacting and using it isn't that great.

The same is the case with the Quad 10.1. The tablet didn't lag or crash as much as the 9.7, but it did give us trouble nonetheless. The resolution of the 10-inch tablet isn't as crisp as the Quad 9.7 but it is good. Once again, this tablet too had issues of lag, stutter and random app crashes. Off all the Zync tablets, the Quad 8.0 is the one that we were most happy with.

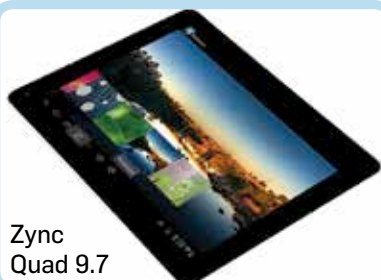
Moving on to the Simmtronics XPAD Mini, the device is quite comfortable to use. It ran all the apps we threw at it with absolute ease. The touch of the tablet isn't the best, but considering the price point, it is a good performer. Running on Android 4.2, the tablet gives you access to the lock screen apps, which is a nice touch. On full brightness, the display is quite vibrant and has good viewing angles. Watching videos on the tablet is a treat. The keyboard is comfortable to type on in the portrait mode. In landscape mode



Ceros revolution

however, the keyboard feels a bit small. It is stock Android and quite responsive. The tablet has its own share of issues as well. Leaving an app and coming back to the home screen takes its own sweet time and there were moments when we were interacting with the display but nothing happened for a bit. Games run on the tablet but the heavy ones, such as Dead Trigger lag a lot even with basic action on screen.

The iberry Auxus Core X4 3G tablet, as the name suggest shows off the ability to house a SIM card. This is not only used for data consumption via 3G but for making calls as well. The calling capability of the tablet isn't great. It's too big to hold near your ear at 9.7-inches. There is no ear-piece and if you forget your headset at home, you have to rely on the built-in speaker, which isn't great. The quality of the microphone too could have been better. Having said that, the tablet did receive the 4.2 Jelly Bean update. It didn't happen OTA. We had to download the update, transfer it to a microSD card and then install it on the tablet. We faced a bit of stutter while playing MKV video but all other formats ran well on the tablet. The performance of games such as Dead Trigger was good on the tablet and the device is big enough to



Zync Quad 9.7